Section II

Reading

Take turns and read this section aloud.

On the day of his travel, Vetri **boarded** the train, his memory went back to his schooldays. They lived in the beautiful village Keelakudi, near Coimbatore. The village had a middle school in the outskirts. It is in that school where Vetri had met Asif. The students and teachers of the school would never forget Vetri and Asif and their friendship. They were always together in learning and playing.

Their friendship started on the first day of school. When Vetri's parents dropped him at the school, he started crying. Asif **consoled** him with a chocolate and said, "Don't cry. We will play after the bell." After that day, they stayed together, played together and even **exchanged** their food. Their friendship grew stronger with time. They were always good in studies and helping each other in studies. They also helped others with their lessons.

One day there was a quarrel between Vetri and Asif's families, and both families stopped talking to each other. To everyone's surprise they continued to be good friends. There was always a healthy **competition** between them. Surprisingly the exam, the results and the marks never **affected** their friendship. Their friendship continued till tenth standard. Then Vetri moved to Coimbatore and Asif to Chennai. Asif started his business in Chennai and settled there. Vetri always wanted to meet his friend but never had the chance to visit Chennai.

Glossary

boarded	-	get on or into a vehicle
consoled	-	comfort someone at the time of grief
exchanged	-	give something and receive something
competition	-	an event or contest
affected	-	cause a change in someone or something

Say True or False.

1. Keelakudi was the native of Vetri.
2. The school was a middle school.
3. Vetri and Asif were good in studies.
4. Vetri never visited Chennai.
5. Asif was a businessman.

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